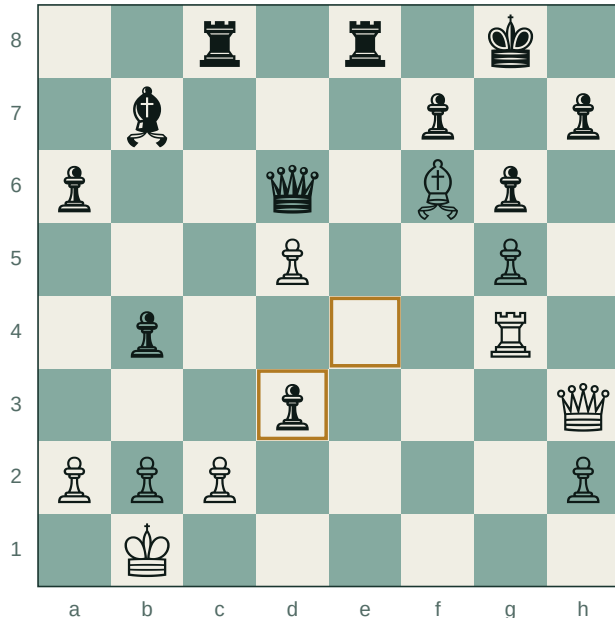


Attraction tactics: White, move 24

Attraction tactics

White to move



Previous move: 23...exd3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

24. Qxh7+ Kxh7 25. Rh4+ Kg8 26. Rh8#

24.Qxh7+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. The move also takes the pawn on h7. Recorded reply: **24...Kxh7**.

25.Rh4+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **25...Kg8**.

26.Rh8# Mate: rook on h8 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on g8. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on h8. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The opponent may decline the offered material. Compare refusal with the recorded continuation before calling the sacrifice forced.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Attraction draws a piece onto a square where a later tactic becomes possible. Sacrifices often work by changing the king's or queen's location rather than winning immediately.

HOW TO LOOK

Ask which enemy piece must be moved to a specific square for your next check, fork, or mating pattern to work.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: bishop on b7 and queen on d6. Check for tactical protection.